

Survival tactics for documenting retaliation, protecting career, and deciding when to leave — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

START YOUR INCIDENT LOG

- ☐ **Start Your Incident Log:** Open a secure personal document tonight and title it your incident log — it must be stored somewhere your employer cannot access like a personal cloud account.
- ☐ **Start Your Incident Log:** Record every retaliatory event with exact dates, times, locations, and the names of any witnesses or participants present during each incident.
- ☐ **Start Your Incident Log:** Write down the specific impact of each incident on your work assignments, career trajectory, or professional reputation to prove the cumulative damage.
- ☐ **Start Your Incident Log:** Track your complaint filing date alongside the timeline of negative treatment to establish the pattern that proves your complaint came first.

PROTECT YOUR EVIDENCE

- ☐ **Protect Your Evidence:** Save all work emails, Slack messages, and calendar invites that document your assignments, performance, and communications before you lose access to them.
- ☐ **Protect Your Evidence:** Store copies of all written performance reviews, feedback documents, and assignment confirmations in your personal email so you control the copies.
- ☐ **Protect Your Evidence:** Keep physical or digital backup copies at home or with a trusted person outside your workplace to ensure evidence survives any device revocation.
- ☐ **Protect Your Evidence:** Never store your incident log or evidence on company devices, company email, shared drives, or any system your employer can monitor or delete.

MAKE STRATEGIC MOVES

- ☐ **Make Strategic Moves:** Refrain from filing additional complaints or confronting your manager right now — these reactions typically worsen your position and give them justification for more retaliation.

 - ☐ **Make Strategic Moves:** Identify three colleagues who witnessed your work quality or treatment and maintain those professional relationships as potential references for future opportunities.

 - ☐ **Make Strategic Moves:** Quietly update your resume and start exploring external opportunities without signaling distress to employers who may still be watching your activity.

 - ☐ **Make Strategic Moves:** Decide whether to stay or leave based on documented facts rather than panic — your incident log should show whether this situation has a viable path forward or requires an exit.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.